

Sesame Turquoise Baker

Senior People & Culture Leader

HR Transformation ◆ Talent & Leadership ◆ Strategic HR Business Partner

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PROFILE

People & Culture leader with 15+ years in global organisations and a start-up, including Siemens Wind Power, The LEGO Group, Carlsberg, Lantmännen Unibake, Uniscale and YNV Group. My experience spans HR transformation, talent and leadership development, and strategic HR business partnering, most recently leading a People & Culture transformation across 11 countries.

No two organisations are the same, and I don't apply a set formula. I listen before I design, bring structure to complexity and drive practical solutions through to implementation, working with everyone from the CEO to frontline employees.

I am looking for a senior People & Culture role in HR Transformation, Talent & Leadership Development, or Strategic HR Business Partnering, ideally where all three come together.



EXPERIENCE

May 2026 – Present

Career Break

Professional development, including Systems Thinking (MIT xPRO).

Nov 2024 – May 2026

Global Head of HR Transformation

YNV Group | Remote

Privately held investment and operating group in technology, financial services and real estate.

Core team of 3 direct reports

- Led a People & Culture transformation across 11 countries, partnering with the Chief HR Officer (CHRO) on the strategy, operating model, governance and technology backbone.
- Delivered a 12-initiative portfolio, aligned the executive team on the roadmap with foundations first: data, process and governance before AI.
- Stood up a global tiered shared services function in four months, supporting around 3,000 employees at 80% service level agreement (SLA) compliance and 4.8/5 service quality. Created a robust roadmap for the rest-of-world roll-out.
- Established Microsoft Dynamics 365 (D365) as the single source of truth for People data and redesigned a legacy organisation structure in D365 to reflect reality, cutting complexity by around 70%.
- Centralised employee documentation across 11 countries in D365, reducing audit risk and GDPR exposure. Audited 300+ contractors and brought around 90 approved contractors into D365 with approval workflows, bringing together HR, Procurement, Finance and business leaders.
- Designed and built two People & Culture knowledge intranet sites (one for all employees, one for HR colleagues) and an 'Ask HR' AI agent proof of concept.

May 2022 – Nov 2024

Chief People Officer

Uniscale (previously PatientSky) | Copenhagen

PatientSky: healthcare SaaS company with around 300 employees, sold to EG. Uniscale: software development platform (PaaS).

Team of 4 direct reports

- Executive People leader and adviser to the CEO and leadership team through commercial scale-up and a company sale.
- Designed a scalable People operating model and partnered with the executive team on organisation design and workforce planning.
- Created a job architecture and pay grades, establishing career pathways and pay ranges to support hiring, pay equity, performance discussions and workforce budgeting.
- Built a customer experience team in Copenhagen and a sales hub in Barcelona as the company moved from R&D to a commercial organisation.

- Introduced performance standards and calibration for the leadership team, and defined succession for critical roles.
- Coached C-suite leaders on leadership effectiveness, team dynamics and people-critical decisions.
- Supported HR due diligence for the sale of PatientSky to EG (around NOK 800m).

Jan 2021 – Apr 2022

Global Talent Development Director

Lantmännen Unibake | Copenhagen

- Led the global leadership and talent agenda across 12 countries, partnering with the CHRO.
- Scaled leadership capability to around 500 leaders through a blended learning journey and a train-the-trainer model.
- Ran global talent reviews and succession calibration and built executive dashboards to support key talent decisions.
- Designed and implemented a global competency framework proof of concept for HR, Marketing & Sales, and Procurement.

Mar 2019 – Dec 2020

Senior Global Talent Manager

Carlsberg Group | Copenhagen

- Managed the global Leadership Academy on a budget of around €1m, running training, revising the offering and coordinating participants.
- Co-created the Carlsberg Leadership Framework and the revised TripleA values.
- Co-created Carlsberg's first Diversity, Equity & Inclusion (DEI) strategy and roadmap, and a COVID-19 toolbox for leaders.
- Took part in design-thinking HR process sprints, facilitated by Implement Consulting, to improve core HR processes.

Nov 2017 – Feb 2019

Global HR Development Manager

TAJCO Group A/S | Vejle

Global supplier of premium exterior trim to the automotive industry, with R&D in Germany and China and manufacturing in China.

Team of 2 direct reports

- Led leadership and capability development across Europe, the US and China, including facilitating situational leadership (SLX) training across sites.
- Designed a skills and competency matrix for the 1,000-employee plant in Ningbo, China.

Dec 2016 – Nov 2017

Senior Global Manager, People, Organisation & Development

The LEGO Group | Billund

- Strategic partner to the General Manager of LEGO Education and member of its leadership team.
- Built the business case for a new global onboarding model, setting out the financial, performance and social costs of 'non-boarding'.
- Co-designed the new global onboarding model with the global and regional onboarding teams, protecting LEGO culture through high growth.

Dec 2015 – Nov 2016

Global Manager, People, Executive HR

The LEGO Group | Billund

- Matured the global performance management framework and delivered executive talent insight to the Executive Leadership Team (ELT).
- Trained HR community for the Performance Management process with the year's focus on DEI and how to reduce biases in performance management.

Dec 2013 – Nov 2015

Head of International Mobility & HR Service Desk

Siemens Wind Power | Brande

Led two teams: International Mobility (12) and AskHR (6)

- Led an HR Service Desk for 7,000 employees (3,500 cases a month, 8/10 satisfaction), managed around 2,000 delegations a year and supported the move of centres of expertise to Prague, Lisbon and India.
- Carried out the 2014 Siemens global maturity assessment of AskHR with HQ: rated Professional overall and World Class for 100% employee reach and 90%+ of phone queries solved first time.

- Led change and communication for the OneHR strategy in Denmark as part of the HR leadership team, including a management roadshow, change agents and pulse checks.

Sep 2012 – Dec 2013

Manager, AskHR (HR Service Desk)

Siemens Wind Power | Brande

Team of 6 direct reports

- Set up and led AskHR, the single point of contact for HR for around 7,000 employees across 8 Siemens companies, 4 sectors and 15 sites in Denmark.
- Core member of the team that designed the HR service delivery model, then led go-live and scale-up, building a customer-first culture across five HR service lines and reaching 81.5% first-time resolution.

Sep 2010 – Sep 2012

HR Business Partner

Siemens Wind Power | Brande

- HR Business Partner to leaders across Global Projects, Sales & Marketing, Service and EMEA, supporting populations of 250 to 1,500 across salaried and hourly-paid teams.
- Partnered leaders on organisation design, workforce planning and performance.

Jul 2008 – Sep 2010

Business Development & Strategy Coordinator

Siemens Wind Power | Brande

- Supported the Director of Business Development & Strategy on global market planning.

CERTIFICATIONS

- Systems Thinking, MIT xPRO, 2026 (in progress)
- Professional Scrum Product Owner (PSPO I), Scrum.org, 2026
- Fundamentals of Artificial Intelligence in HR, Hacking HR, 2024
- Co-Active Professional Coach, CTI, 2024
- Certified Change Management Professional (CCMP), 2023
- Co-Active Leadership Experience, CTI, 2022
- Positive Psychology, University of Pennsylvania, 2021
- Hogan Certified, Hogan Assessments, 2018
- Situational Leadership (SLX) Train the Trainer, Blanchard, 2017
- DISC/GIA Certified, Thomas International

SKILLS

HR Transformation: Organisational Transformation | HR Operating Models | Shared Services | HR Service Delivery | HR Information Systems (HRIS) & People Data (D365) | AI in HR | Change Management | Systems Thinking | Programme & Portfolio Management

Talent & Leadership: Talent & Succession | Leadership Development | Performance Management | Competency Frameworks | People Analytics | Executive Coaching | Facilitation | Diversity, Equity & Inclusion (DEI)

HR Business Partnering: Strategic HR Business Partnering | Organisation Design | Workforce Planning | Employee Experience & Onboarding | International Mobility | M&A Due Diligence | Stakeholder Management

EDUCATION & LANGUAGES

HNC Business Management (Merit) Arden University, 2018

Languages: English (native), Danish (working knowledge, FVU Level 3)

ADDITIONAL INFORMATION

British citizen, living in Denmark since 2006 with permanent residence. Passed the Danish citizenship test (Indfødsretsprøven), June 2026. Interests: reading, travelling, art and fashion.